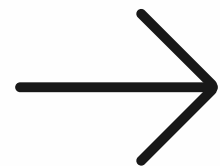
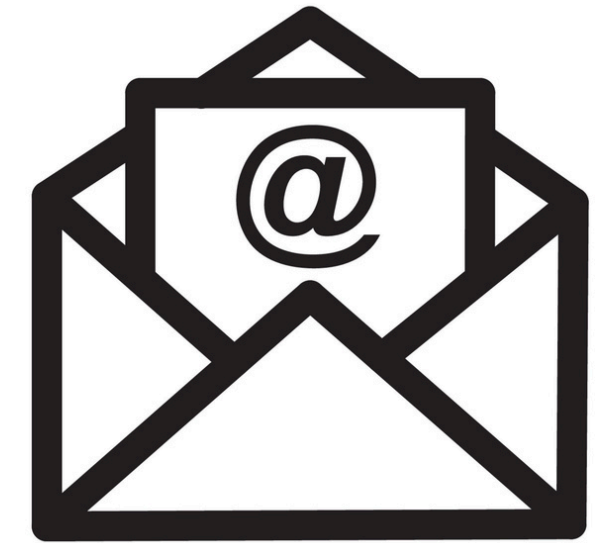


PHISHING DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

By,
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1. INTRODUCTION



Email is widely used for communication, but it is also a major target for cyber attacks.

Phishing is a common attack where fake emails trick users into sharing sensitive information.

Attackers pretend to be trusted organizations to steal passwords, OTPs, or personal data.

These attacks focus on human mistakes, not system weaknesses.

SAMPLE EMAIL ANALYSIS

Email Overview

- Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked
- Message: Requests immediate verification via a link
- Goal: Trick user into clicking a malicious link

Identified red flags

- Generic Greeting
- Uses “Dear User” instead of your real name → shows it’s not personalized
- Urgency & Fear Tactics
- “Account will be locked in 24 hours” → creates panic to force quick action
- Suspicious Link
- Link looks official but leads to a fake website designed to steal data
- Untrusted Sender
- Email address does not match the official company domain



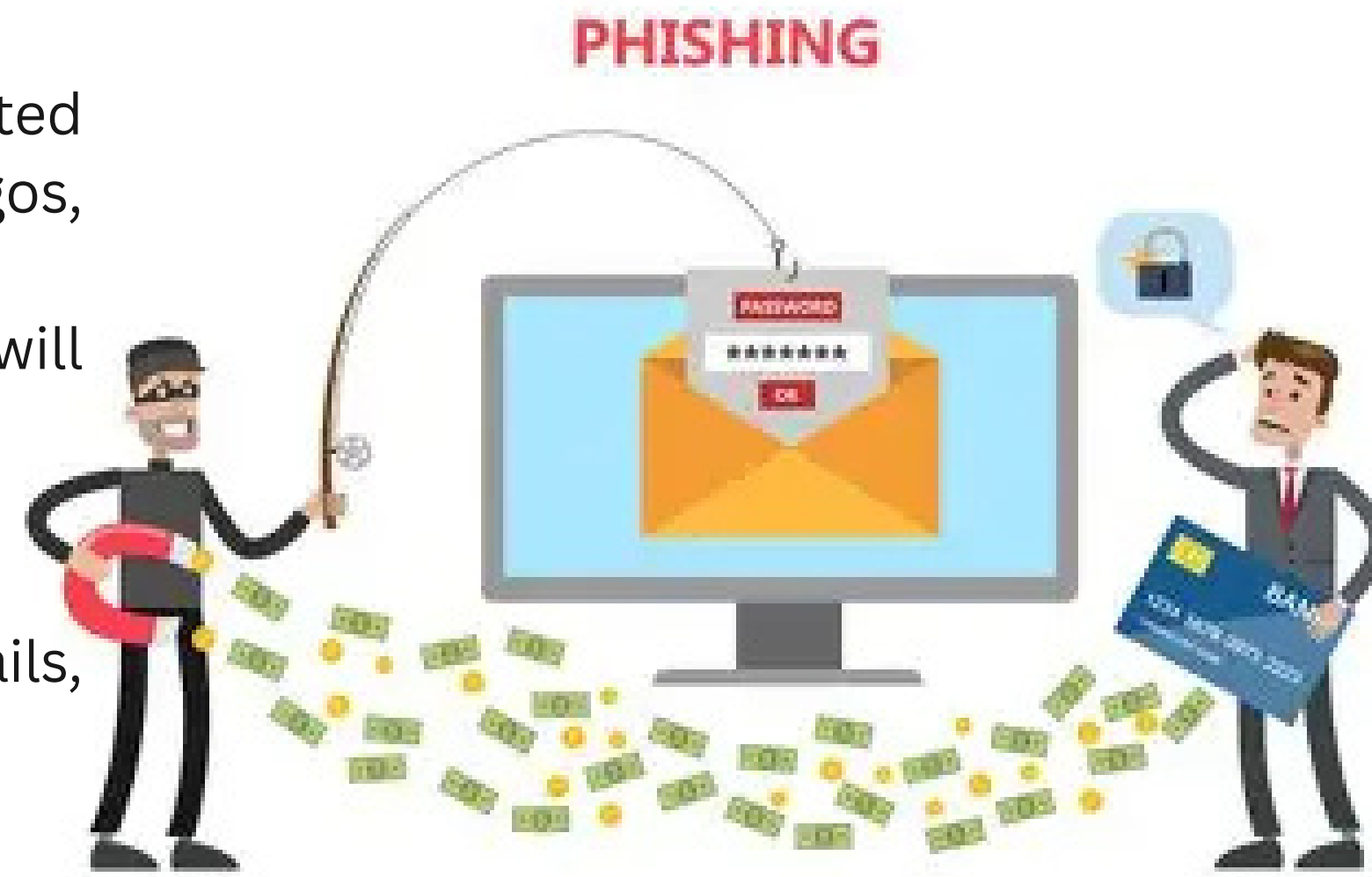
Email Analytics

ATTACK EXPLANATION

Phishing attacks are designed to manipulate users psychologically rather than hack systems directly. The attacker creates an email that looks trustworthy and urgent to trick the user into taking immediate action.

Step-by-Step Attack Flow

- **Fake Email Sent-** Attacker sends an email pretending to be a trusted organization (bank, social media, etc.). Uses official-looking logos, names, and formatting
- **Creates Urgency & Fear-** Message includes warnings like “Account will be locked”. Forces user to act quickly without thinking
- **Malicious Link Provided-** Email contains a link that looks real
- Redirects to a fake website (phishing page)
- **User Falls for the Trap-** User clicks the link and enters login details, OTP, or personal data
- **Data Theft & Misuse-** Attacker collects the information
- Uses it for hacking accounts, fraud, or identity theft



PREVENTION GUIDELINES

Do's (Safe Practices)

- Verify the Sender
- Always check the email address carefully. Legitimate companies use official domains.
- Check Links Before Clicking
- Hover over links to see the real URL. Avoid clicking suspicious or shortened links.
- Use Official Websites
- Instead of clicking email links, manually visit the official website.
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)
- Adds an extra layer of security even if your password is compromised.
- Report Suspicious Emails
- Inform your organization or email provider about phishing attempts.

Don'ts (Avoid These Mistakes)

- Don't Click Unknown Links
- Especially if the email creates urgency or fear.
- Don't Share Sensitive Information
- Never share passwords, OTPs, or banking details via email.
- Don't Download Unknown Attachments
- They may contain malware or viruses.
- Don't Trust Urgent Messages Blindly
- Always verify before taking action.



CONCLUSION

Phishing attacks remain one of the most common and effective cyber threats, mainly because they exploit human behavior rather than technical vulnerabilities. Attackers use simple but powerful techniques such as urgency, fear, and trust to deceive users into sharing sensitive information. Through this project, we analyzed phishing email samples and identified key indicators like suspicious links, generic greetings, and untrusted sender addresses. These signs help in distinguishing between legitimate and malicious emails.

The analysis shows that even basic awareness can significantly reduce the risk of falling victim to phishing attacks. By carefully verifying email sources, avoiding unknown links, and following safe practices, users can protect their personal and professional data.

In conclusion, cybersecurity is not only the responsibility of organizations but also of individual users. Staying informed, alert, and cautious is the most effective way to defend against phishing attacks.

